Summary

117 participants registered and 75 gave valid answers for ‘Overall Preference’, the main trait of this report.

8 items were tested. Each participant tested 3 of them.

Taking all answers together, the items with the best performance for ‘Overall Preference’ were Hybrid 03, Hybrid 06 and Hybrid 08.

1 of the items tested outperformed the check Hybrid 04 with statistical confidence ($p < 0.05$) for the main trait, namely Hybrid 03.

2 trait(s) were left out because they had too few valid answers, namely Flood tolerance [Vegetative] and Flood tolerance [Reproductive].

In their open answers, 84 participants talked most about early maturity and cob size. The most praised was early maturity, 71 % of its 45 mentions were positive. The main complaint was fall armyworm damage, 77 % of its 44 mentions were negative.

“ready before the rains stopped with Hybrid 01”

Results by group of participants are in the section ‘Differences between groups’.

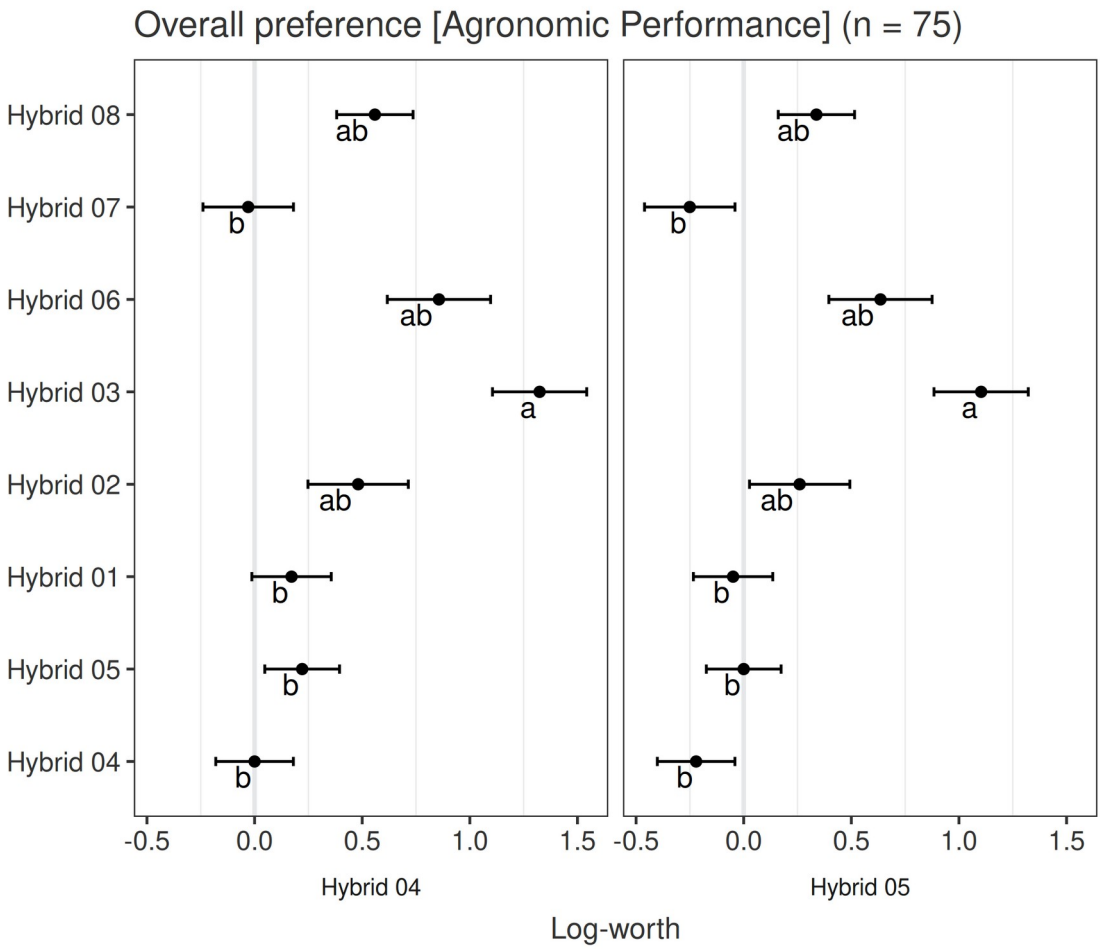


Figure 10. Log-worth of the items for 'Overall Preference'.

Why they preferred it

The open answers read by Sikia Analytics say why participants ranked the Overall Preference as they did. Table 5 lists, for every option, the topics with mostly positive mentions and those with mostly negative mentions, with the number of mentions in brackets.

Hybrid 03, the item ranked first, was praised for storage weevils (5), drought tolerance (4). The complaints were about early maturity (13), lodging (4), fall armyworm damage (3).

Table 5. What participants said about each of the items, from the open answers read by Sikia Analytics. Options in the order of the ranking for Overall Preference.

Option	Praised for	Complaints about	Mentions
Hybrid 03	storage weevils (5), drought tolerance (4)	early maturity (13), lodging (4), fall armyworm damage (3)	37
Hybrid 06	fall armyworm damage (9), cob size (5), lodging (3)	drought tolerance (3), storage weevils (2)	42
Hybrid 02	cob size (7), lodging (4)	early maturity (12), drought tolerance (6), fall armyworm damage (6)	43
Hybrid 05	early maturity (7), lodging (6), drought tolerance (3)	taste (8), fall armyworm damage (6), seed cost (6)	43

What participants said in their own words

Besides ranking the options, participants answered open questions in their own words, by text or voice. Sikia Analytics read 84 answers and found 254 mentions of 9 different topics, such as a trait, a pest or a quality, each with the feeling expressed about it. The labels and sentiments are reported as Sikia returned them, with their counts, so readers can weigh them.

Figure 19 shows the 9 most mentioned topics. Bars to the right count positive mentions, bars to the left negative ones, and grey bars neutral ones. The number at the end of each bar is the total.

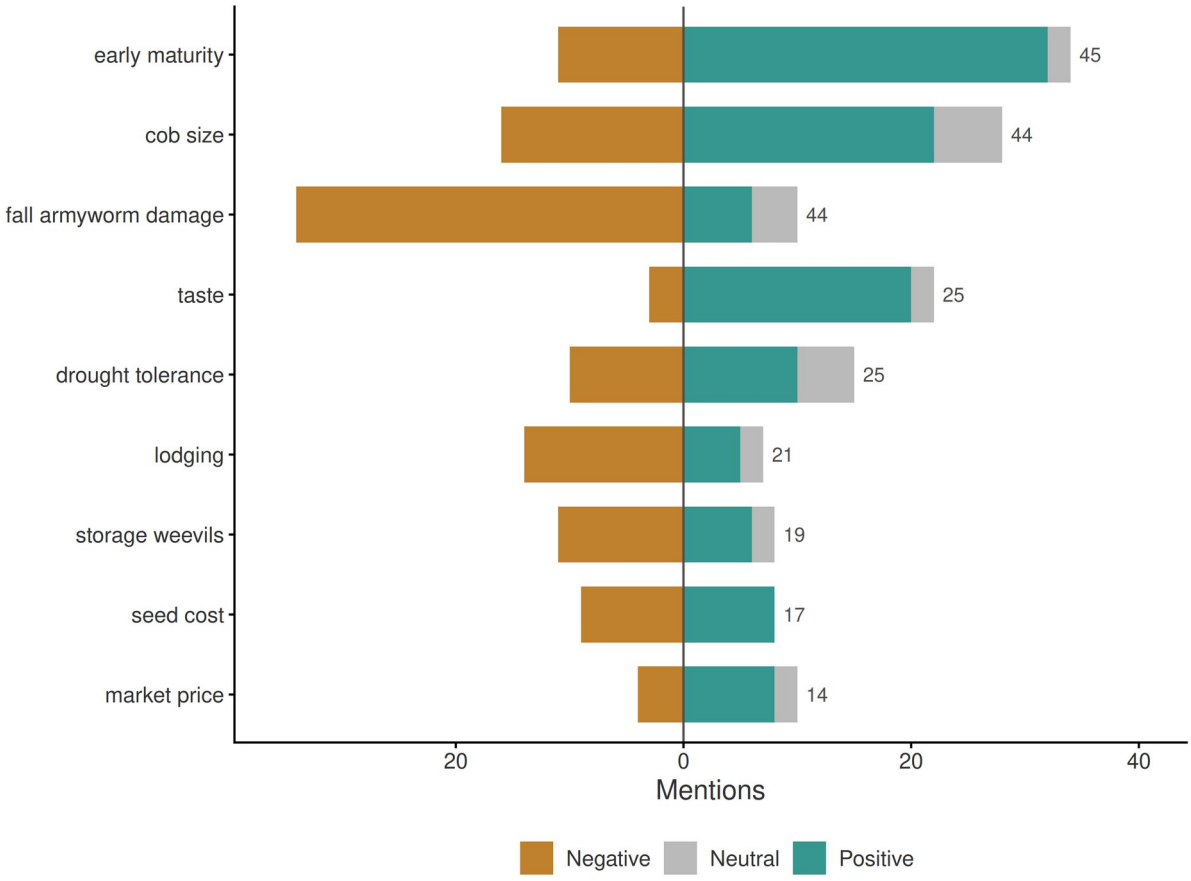


Figure 19. Topics mentioned by participants in their open answers, and the sentiment of each mention, as read by Sikia Analytics.

Sikia linked part of the mentions to the items they were about. Figure 20 shows, for each items and topic, the number of mentions and whether they were mostly positive (teal) or negative (brown).

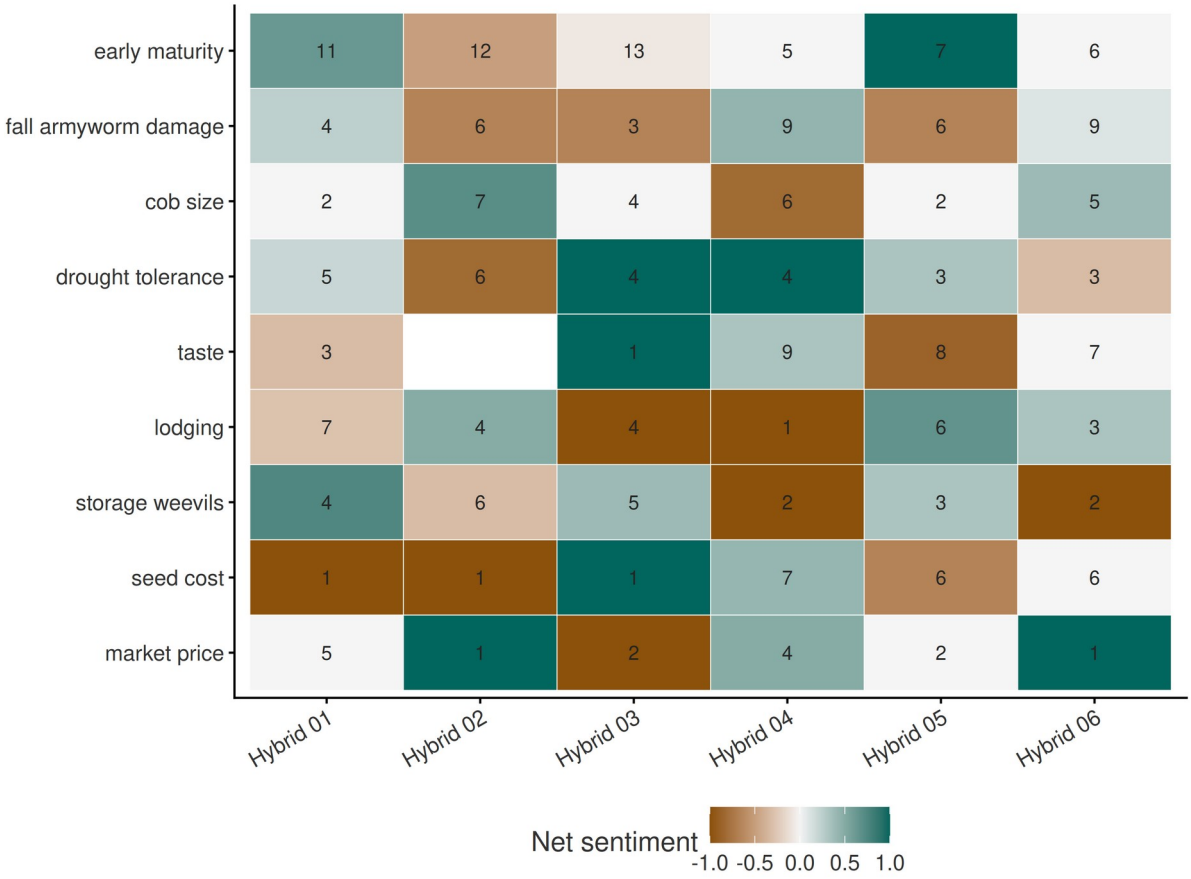


Figure 20. Mentions by Item and topic. Numbers are mentions, colour is the net sentiment, from all negative (brown) to all positive (teal).

In their words

One positive and one negative quote for the most mentioned topics, chosen by Sikia's confidence in the reading. They are the words of individual participants, not a summary.

Table 17. Quotes from the open answers, by topic and sentiment.

Topic	Sentiment	Quote
early maturity	Positive	ready before the rains stopped with Hybrid 01
early maturity	Negative	still green when the others were dry with Hybrid 01
cob size	Positive	cobs filled to the tip with Hybrid 05
cob size	Negative	small cobs with Hybrid 01
fall armyworm damage	Positive	few worms on this one with Hybrid 01
fall armyworm damage	Negative	armyworm ate the leaves with Hybrid 01
taste	Positive	soft and tasty with Hybrid 02
taste	Negative	hard to chew with Hybrid 04
drought tolerance	Positive	survived the dry spell in February with Hybrid 02
drought tolerance	Negative	wilted when the rains failed with Hybrid 01

Topics across all answers

Sikia grouped similar mentions into 7 topics in 3 broader categories (Table 18). Topics show what participants kept returning to, including things the trial did not ask about.

Table 18. Topics found by Sikia across all open answers, with the number of mentions and representative phrases.

Category	Topic	Mentions	Representative phrases
Growing season	Early maturity and escape from drought	70	ready before the rains stopped · kept green with little rain · harvested earliest of the three
Pests in field and store	Fall armyworm and spraying	44	armyworm ate the leaves · had to spray twice
Harvest, food and money	Cob size and filling	44	big cobs with full rows · many empty tips
Harvest, food and money	Seed cost and market	31	sold at a good price · seed too expensive for next season
Harvest, food and money	Eating quality	25	sweet when roasted · children liked the ugali from it
Growing season	Standing in wind	21	stood well in the wind · fell over after the storm
Pests in field and store	Weevils in storage	19	stored for months without weevils · weevils came within weeks

Sikia’s reading of free text is automatic and can miss or misread an answer. Counts of mentions are not counts of participants, as one answer can carry several mentions. The results were produced by Sikia Analytics on 2026-10-20 and are shared through ClimMob. The mentions table is in extra-outputs/sikia-mentions.csv.